

D356

HR Technology

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A recruiting team wants software that posts openings, collects applications, screens résumés by keyword, and tracks candidates through interview stages. The team has eight recruiters, and its budget was approved in March. Which system does it need?

- A. Budgeting software, since the budget was just approved.
- B. A learning management system (LMS).
- C. An applicant tracking system (ATS).
- D. A payroll module in the HRIS.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A company needs to assign compliance courses, track who completes them, and issue certificates. Which system fits?

- A. An applicant tracking system (ATS).
- B. A performance management system.
- C. Any HRIS, since every HRIS does everything.
- D. A learning management system (LMS).

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A 1,200-employee manufacturer wants a new human capital management suite. A vendor gave an impressive demo at a trade show in Las Vegas. What should the HR team do first?

- A. Run a needs analysis: document processes and requirements with stakeholders, then evaluate vendors.
- B. Sign with the vendor that gave the best demo.
- C. Customize every feature to match current processes exactly.
- D. Go live quickly and fix problems later.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

An HR dashboard shows 1,340 active employees while payroll shows 1,295. Terminations are entered in payroll but not always in the HRIS. The dashboard uses a modern color theme. What is the root problem?

- A. The color theme makes the numbers hard to read.
- B. Data integrity: the systems are not synchronized, so the HRIS keeps people who have left.
- C. Payroll is wrong because its number is lower.
- D. The company needs a predictive model of headcount.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

An HR analyst builds a model that estimates each employee's probability of leaving in the next 12 months based on tenure, pay ratio, and manager changes. The model runs in Python on the company's cloud. Which type of analytics is this?

- A. Diagnostic, because it is coded in Python.
- B. Prescriptive.
- C. Descriptive.
- D. Predictive.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which question is prescriptive?

- A. Who is likely to leave next year?
- B. Which retention action should we take for each at-risk team to lower turnover cost?
- C. Why did turnover rise in the second quarter?
- D. What was last year's turnover rate?

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A department of 50 employees had 75 days of unplanned absence during a month with 20 workdays. The department uses a new time-clock app. What is the absence rate?

- A. 7.5%
- B. 13.3%
- C. 1.5 days
- D. 375%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A 40-person team had an absence rate of 5 percent over 22 workdays. How many days of absence were there?

- A.** 44
- B.** 2
- C.** 1.1
- D.** 17,600

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A benefits specialist needs employees' dependent information to process enrollments. The HRIS administrator gives the whole HR department access to every field, including Social Security numbers and medical leave notes, to keep things simple. The HRIS was upgraded last fall. What is best practice?

- A.** Keep department-wide access for efficiency.
- B.** Set role-based access so each person sees only the fields their job requires.
- C.** Remove all access, including the specialist's.
- D.** Roll back last fall's upgrade.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A mid-size company with a two-person IT team wants an HR system with automatic updates and little server maintenance. It has offices in three states and holds its all-hands meeting each December. Which deployment fits best?

- A.** A custom system built in-house.
- B.** On-premises servers in the main office.
- C.** Cloud-based software as a service (SaaS).
- D.** Whichever option is easiest to demo at the December all-hands.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

People analytics finds that employees who attend optional wellness seminars have 30 percent lower turnover. The seminars are held in the new fitness center on Thursdays. An executive proposes making them mandatory to cut turnover. What is the best response?

- A.** Mandate them, since the data proves seminars cause retention.
- B.** Cancel the seminars, since the data is useless.
- C.** Caution that the link may reflect who chooses to attend; test with a controlled pilot before mandating.
- D.** Move the seminars off Thursdays.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which design best tests whether a mentoring program causes higher retention?

- A.** Skip testing, since mentoring always improves retention.
- B.** Compare employees who volunteered for mentoring with those who did not.
- C.** Survey the mentors on whether it works.
- D.** Randomly assign eligible new hires to mentoring or no mentoring, then compare retention.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

A recruiting team wants software that posts openings, collects applications, screens résumés by keyword, and tracks candidates through interview stages. ~~The team has eight recruiters, and its budget was approved in March.~~ Which system does it need?

Target word: system type **Decides:** Recruiting workflow.

A	Camouflage	The budget date does not decide the system.
B	Confusion set	An LMS manages training.
C	Correct	An ATS manages postings, applicants, and hiring stages.
D	Adjacent category	Payroll handles pay for current employees.

2. Answer D Concept 1 • transfer

A company needs to assign compliance courses, track who completes them, and issue certificates. Which system fits?

Target word: system type — reverse **Decides:** Courses and completions.

A	Confusion set	An ATS manages candidates, not employee training.
B	Adjacent category	It tracks goals and reviews, not course completions.
C	Absolute language	Core HRIS products differ in what they cover.
D	Correct	An LMS assigns and tracks training.

3. Answer A Concept 2

A 1,200-employee manufacturer wants a new human capital management suite. A vendor gave an impressive demo ~~at a trade show in Las Vegas.~~ What should the HR team do first?

Target word: first step **Decides:** No requirements yet.

A	Correct	Requirements come before selection.
B	Camouflage	A good demo does not show fit.
C	Absolute language	Heavy customization raises cost and risk and skips process review.
D	Dropped element	Drops planning and testing.

4. Answer B Concept 3

An HR dashboard shows 1,340 active employees while payroll shows 1,295. Terminations are entered in payroll but not always in the HRIS. ~~The dashboard uses a modern color theme.~~ What is the root problem?

Target word: root problem **Decides:** Terminations missing from the HRIS.

A	Camouflage	Design does not change the counts.
B	Correct	Unintegrated entry causes records to drift.
C	Inverted operation	Payroll has the terminations; the HRIS is missing them.
D	Adjacent category	Analytics on bad data repeats the error.

5. Answer D Concept 4

An HR analyst builds a model that estimates each employee's probability of leaving in the next 12 months based on tenure, pay ratio, and manager changes. ~~The model runs in Python on the company's cloud.~~ Which type of analytics is this?

Target word: analytics type **Decides:** Estimates future likelihood.

A	Camouflage	The language does not decide the type.
B	Adjacent category	Prescriptive recommends actions; this gives probabilities.
C	Confusion set	Descriptive reports what already happened.
D	Correct	It forecasts what is likely to happen.

6. Answer B Concept 4 • transfer

Which question is prescriptive?

Target word: prescriptive question — reverse **Decides:** Asks what action to take.

A	Adjacent category	Predictive; one step short of action.
B	Correct	Recommends an action.
C	Inverted operation	Diagnostic: looks back to explain, not forward to act.
D	Confusion set	Descriptive.

7. Answer A Concept 5

A department of 50 employees had 75 days of unplanned absence during a month with 20 workdays. ~~The department uses a new time clock app.~~ What is the absence rate?

Target word: absence rate **Decides:** $75 \div (50 \times 20)$.

A	Correct	$75 \div 1,000$ scheduled days = 7.5%.
B	Inverted operation	$1,000 \div 75$ flips the ratio.
C	Adjacent category	Days per employee, not a rate.
D	Dropped element	$75 \div 20$ leaves out headcount.

8. Answer A Concept 5 • transfer

A 40-person team had an absence rate of 5 percent over 22 workdays. How many days of absence were there?

Target word: solve for days **Decides:** $0.05 \times 40 \times 22$.

A	Correct	880 scheduled days $\times 0.05 = 44$.
B	Dropped element	40×0.05 leaves out workdays.
C	Wrong stem number	22×0.05 leaves out headcount.
D	Inverted operation	$880 \div 0.05$ divides instead of multiplying.

9. Answer B Concept 6

A benefits specialist needs employees' dependent information to process enrollments. The HRIS administrator gives the whole HR department access to every field, including Social Security numbers and medical leave notes, to keep things simple. ~~The HRIS was upgraded last fall.~~ What is best practice?

Target word: access decision **Decides:** Access should match each role's needs.

A	Inverted operation	Maximizes exposure of sensitive data.
B	Correct	Least privilege protects sensitive data.
C	Absolute language	The specialist needs some access to work.
D	Camouflage	The upgrade did not cause the access problem.

10. Answer C Concept 7

A mid-size company with a two-person IT team wants an HR system with automatic updates and little server maintenance. ~~It has offices in three states and holds its all hands meeting each December.~~ Which deployment fits best?

Target word: deployment model **Decides:** Small IT team, wants vendor-managed updates.

A	Adjacent category	Needs even more IT capacity.
B	Inverted operation	Adds the maintenance they want to avoid.
C	Correct	The vendor handles servers and updates.
D	Camouflage	Meeting timing does not decide deployment.

11. Answer C Concept 8

People analytics finds that employees who attend optional wellness seminars have 30 percent lower turnover. ~~The seminars are held in the new fitness center on Thursdays.~~ An executive proposes making them mandatory to cut turnover. What is the best response?

Target word: best response **Decides:** Attendees chose to attend.

A	Absolute language	Overstates what the data shows.
B	Inverted operation	The data is a lead to test, not worthless.
C	Correct	Correlation from self-selected groups does not prove cause.
D	Camouflage	Scheduling does not decide causation.

12. Answer D Concept 8 • transfer

Which design best tests whether a mentoring program causes higher retention?

Target word: causal test design — reverse **Decides:** Random assignment removes self-selection.

A	Absolute language	Assumes the answer.
B	Dropped element	Drops the self-selection problem.
C	Adjacent category	Opinions do not measure causation.
D	Correct	Random assignment isolates the program's effect.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	4	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	1	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	4	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	7	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Which HR system does what	An ATS manages recruiting; an LMS manages training; an HRIS holds core employee records; an HCM suite combines these.	Assuming any HRIS covers every function.	Postings and candidates (ATS) vs. courses and completions (LMS).
2	Needs analysis before vendor selection	Document requirements and processes with stakeholders before evaluating vendors.	Buying the system with the best demo.	A vendor demo before any requirements exist.
3	Data integrity and integration	When systems are not integrated, records drift apart; fix the source of truth and the data flow before building analytics.	Blaming the dashboard or building models on bad data.	Two systems report different counts.
4	Descriptive, predictive, prescriptive	Descriptive says what happened, diagnostic why, predictive what will likely happen, prescriptive what to do about it.	Calling a probability model prescriptive.	“Likelihood” (predictive) vs. “which action” (prescriptive).
5	Absence rate	$\text{Absence rate} = \frac{\text{days absent}}{(\text{employees} \times \text{workdays})} \times 100$.	Leaving out headcount or workdays.	Absence days, headcount, and a period length.
6	Role-based access	Give each role access only to the fields it needs; protect sensitive data such as Social Security numbers and medical information.	Granting broad access “to keep things simple.”	An admin granting the whole department all fields.
7	Cloud SaaS vs. on-premises	SaaS shifts servers, updates, and maintenance to the vendor; on-premises gives more control but needs in-house IT capacity.	Choosing on-premises with a tiny IT team.	Small IT staff and a desire for automatic updates.
8	Correlation vs. causation	A link in people data does not prove cause; self-selection can create it. Test with a controlled comparison before acting.	Mandating a program because participants do better.	Optional program participants show better outcomes.

Course scope (public description): Technology is transforming HR into a data-driven and strategic function.

This course introduces you to human resource information systems, digital tools, and analytics that improve efficiency and guide better decision-making. By mastering HR technology, you will be equipped to deliver insights that inform strategy and enhance the employee experience.